

Accessibility, Safety & Medical

What the estate can and cannot do, altitude and health guidance, emergency procedures and contacts.

Accessibility: An Honest Assessment

The estate is built into a hillside on four terraces. Parts of it are genuinely accessible and parts of it are not, and we would rather tell you before you book than apologise after you arrive.

Area	Access	Detail
Arrival, reception, lounge	Step-free	Ramped entrance from the car park, 1:12 gradient
The Panorama Pavilion	Step-free	Estate lift; step-free bathroom threshold; 900 mm doorways
The Mist Suite	Not accessible	Fourteen stone steps, no lift
The Obsidian Villa	Partial	Level approach on a 4-min path; internal stairs to the upper floor
The Glasshouse Restaurant	Step-free	Lift access, movable tables
Pool terrace	Step-free to the deck	No pool hoist; entry is by steps into the water
Spa and tub house	Not accessible	Three steps at the entrance; protected structure
Gardens	Partial	Upper terrace paved and level; lower terraces are stepped

If you need step-free

Book The Panorama Pavilion. It is the room we can properly support, with lift access, a step-free bathroom, a roll-in shower with a folding seat and grab rails on both sides of the WC. Tell us at the time of booking and we will send photographs and measurements rather than ask you to trust an adjective.

What we can arrange

- A wheelchair on the estate, on request at booking.
- A vehicle with a folding ramp for transfers, with 72 hours' notice.
- Meals served anywhere you prefer, at no extra charge.
- Staff assistance on the paths at any hour — dial 9.

Other Access Needs

Vision

- Room orientation on arrival, taking as long as you want.
- Menus read aloud, or sent by WhatsApp in advance to be read on your own device at your own text size.
- Guide dogs and other assistance animals are welcome — they are not covered by our no-pets policy. Tell us in advance so housekeeping is briefed and a relief area is prepared.
- Glass is the material of this building. Every full-height pane in a walkway carries a manifestation strip at eye level, and staff will point out the ones in your room.

Hearing

- Vibrating pillow fire alarms, on request at booking — we hold two.
- A visual door-knock alert for the Pavilion and the Villa.
- The team communicates by WhatsApp as readily as by phone, at any hour, which most guests find easier anyway.
- No hearing loop is installed. We are sorry; it is on the list.

Dietary, medical and neurodiversity

- Fridge space for medication is available in every room; insulin and similar can also be held in the kitchen's monitored fridge.
- A sharps bin will be placed in the room on request.
- The estate is naturally very quiet. The lounge, the yoga studio and the lower garden are the quietest points, and the restaurant is at its busiest between 8:00 and 9:00 PM if you would rather avoid that.
- We will happily agree a 'no unexpected entry' rule for housekeeping, with a fixed service time each day.

Altitude, Health and Acclimatisation

Gangtok sits at about 1,650 m (5,400 ft). That is high enough to notice and low enough that almost nobody has real trouble. The excursions are a different matter: Tsomgo Lake is 12,400 ft and Nathula 14,140 ft, and those are altitudes where people do get ill.

In Gangtok

You may feel breathless on stairs, sleep lightly the first night and dehydrate faster than usual. Drink more water than you think you need, go easy on alcohol the first evening, and do not plan a hard gym session on day one.

Going higher

- Do not attempt Tsomgo or Nathula on your first day. Give yourself 24 hours in Gangtok first.
- **Warning signs:** a headache that painkillers do not touch, nausea, dizziness, breathlessness at rest, confusion. The only reliable treatment is to descend, immediately.
- Tell your driver at the first symptom. Every local driver knows this road and will turn around without argument.
- Diamox is commonly used and commonly misused — talk to your own doctor before you travel, not to a pharmacist at the roadside.
- Not recommended above Tsomgo: pregnancy, significant cardiac or respiratory disease, uncontrolled hypertension, recent surgery.

On the estate

We keep an oxygen cylinder with a mask at reception and the duty manager is trained to use it. It is for stabilising someone while an ambulance comes, not for treatment. A first aid kit and an AED are held at reception; two staff on every shift are trained in basic life support and AED use.

Medical Care and Emergency Contacts

Service	Contact	Distance
Estate reception, 24 hrs	Dial 9 · WhatsApp +91 81015 61812	On site
National emergency number	112	—
Ambulance	108	—
Police	100 · Sadar Police Station, Gangtok	3 km
Fire	101	4 km
STNM Hospital (government, multi-speciality)	0359 220 2059	~4 km · 15 min
Central Referral Hospital, Tadong (private)	0359 227 0221	~6 km · 20 min
24-hour pharmacy, Deorali	—	~3 km
Nearest dentist	Arranged by concierge	~3 km

How we handle a medical situation

Dial 9 from the room, or WhatsApp us, at any hour. The duty manager comes to you, brings the first aid kit and oxygen, calls 108 if needed, and — this matters in Gangtok — sends a staff member ahead in a car to meet the ambulance at the gate, because the approach road is easy to miss in the dark.

A doctor to the room

A local GP will visit the estate, usually within an hour, at ₹1,500–₹2,500 for the consultation. Arranged through reception at any hour.

Serious cases

Sikkim has no facility for major trauma or complex cardiac intervention. Serious cases are stabilised locally and evacuated by road to Siliguri (4 hours) — helicopter evacuation exists but is weather-dependent and cannot be relied upon. **This is the single strongest argument for travel insurance that covers mountain regions and medical repatriation.**

Fire, Utilities and Sustainability

Fire safety

- Smoke detectors in every room and corridor, tested monthly.
- Extinguishers and a fire blanket at each terrace level; the restaurant has a kitchen suppression system.
- The evacuation plan is on the back of your room door. The assembly point is the upper car park, by the gate.
- In an alarm, leave by the marked path, not the lift. Staff sweep every room and confirm a headcount against the register.
- Tampering with a detector is charged at ₹25,000 and ends the stay.

Power and water

A full-load diesel generator picks up within 8 seconds of a grid outage; a battery inverter holds lighting, Wi-Fi and the lift with no break at all. Water is stored on site for three days of full occupancy, filtered and UV-treated, and safe to drink from the tap.

What we do about our footprint

- No single-use plastic anywhere on the estate — Sikkim banned plastic bags in 1998 and we go further, with glass bottles refilled on site.
- Solar thermal for hot water, with electric backup for cloudy weeks.
- Vegetables from the estate terraces and from Sikkim's organic farms; the state has been fully organic since 2016.
- Kitchen waste composted on the lower terrace and returned to the beds.
- Linen changed every third day unless you ask otherwise — the single biggest water saving a hotel can make.
- Staff hired locally and paid year-round, including the monsoon months when occupancy is lowest.